

Colombia: Perceptions of the Economy

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Overview

Overview

Central Question and Motivation

- ▶ The central question for my research was “How do Colombian's Perceive their Economy?”.
- ▶ My motivation for this analysis came from my practicum research that focuses on Colombia and housing for internally displaced people. Economics and housing go hand in hand, and I was curious on how do Colombian's feel generally about their economy, especially in the light of a new President that is leftist.

Data

The data originated from the Latinobarometer for Colombia 2023

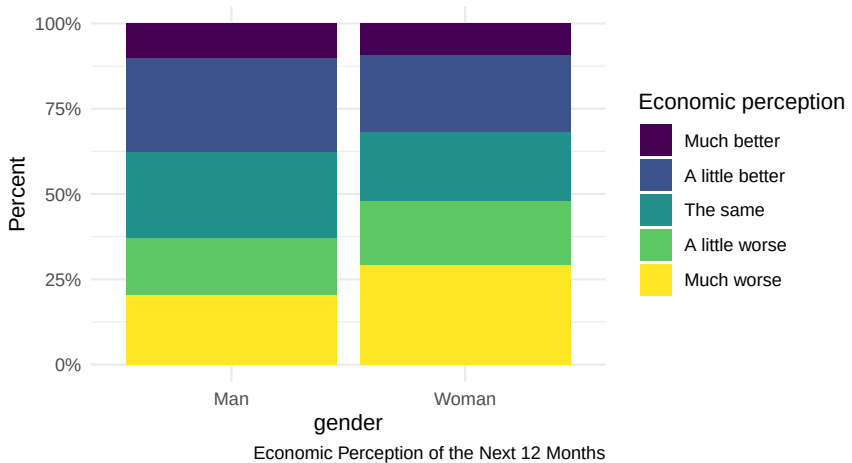
- ▶ I made sure to tidy the data to look at economic based questions.
- ▶ I made sure to include the gender/sex variable to analyze perceptions based on gender.
- ▶ The question that I looked at were directed to perceptions of economic performance.

Tables and Graphs

Table 1: Perception of Colombia's Current Economy By Gender (Colombia 2023)

Response	Men	Women	Total
Very good	0.5	0.3	0.4
Good	9.2	4.4	6.7
About average	56.4	49.0	52.5
Bad	23.5	28.6	26.1
Very bad	10.4	17.6	14.2

Tables and Graphs cont.



Analysis

Men and women have rather similar perceptions of the Colombian economy in 2023. In the first table, 56.4% of Men and 49% of women believed that the economy has performed at the average level. Women seem to be more pessimistic about the performance of the economy. This could be for several factors not covered like household breadwinner, education, socio-economic status, etc. (table 1)

Analysis Pt. 2

In the bar graph, which looked at the perception within the next 12 month of performance, men are much more optimistic of the economy doing better than women. Over 25% of women surveyed believe that the economy will get much worse within the next 12 months (2024)

Conclusion

Although there was pessimism surrounding the economy of Colombia in 2023, there was more positivity of the future performance of the economy from men. President Petro won by large numbers on a platform of reducing poverty and inequality. More women felt that the economic performance of the country would decline. As of late, those women would be correct. As of 2026, Colombia has entered into an economic emergency more than once. It will be interesting to continue following this trend as Colombia is up for a Presidential election this year.